AURORASTAY HOTELS

Booking Terms and Cancellation Policy

Individual transient reservations | US properties | Guest-facing baseline with operational controls

Policy code	AS-01
Effective date	January 1, 2026
Review date	January 1, 2027, or sooner if law, systems, or operating conditions change
Owner	Guest Experience and Property Operations
Applies to	AuroraStay managed and franchised properties in the United States, unless a signed contract or local rule requires a different result

How to use this policy
Use the property code, reservation record, and rate rules before giving a guest a final answer. If a property-specific rule is not stated here, contact the property team and record the exception in the reservation notes.

Document map

Navigation	Focus	Primary use
Opening	Scope and quick reference	Answer common guest questions and identify the controlling rule
Core rule	Detailed policy	Apply the standard rule and its exceptions
Lookup	Tables and property matrix	Compare rate, property, charge, or service requirements
Workflow	Workflow and escalation	Resolve edge cases, document decisions, and escalate when needed

Operating note: This is a business policy for guest service teams. It is not a substitute for a property license, emergency procedure, signed group agreement, or advice from qualified counsel. Local and state requirements can be more protective than this baseline.

1. Scope and governing rules

This policy applies to individual transient reservations made through an AuroraStay website, call center, property, authorized travel advisor, or approved online travel agency. The reservation confirmation controls when it contains a rate rule that is more specific than this baseline. Group, negotiated corporate, government, wholesale, crew, and extended-stay agreements may have separate written terms.

The reservation record must show the property, arrival and departure dates, room type, number of guests, rate plan, payment method, cancellation deadline, taxes and disclosed fees. Staff must read the exact rate plan before promising a cancellation, change, refund, upgrade, or fee waiver.

Guest-facing summary
Flexible rates can normally be canceled by 6:00 PM local property time one day before arrival without a room charge. Advance Purchase rates are generally non-refundable and cannot be changed. The confirmation controls if it states a different rule.

2. Rate plan rules

Rate plan	Payment	Cancel or change	Staff action
Flexible	Card guarantee; payment at hotel unless confirmation says otherwise	Cancel by 6:00 PM local property time one day before arrival. Later cancellation or no-show is one night plus applicable tax.	Quote the deadline in local property time and note the confirmation number.
Advance Purchase	Full stay charged at booking	Non-refundable and non-changeable except where the confirmation, law, or an approved service recovery permits an exception.	Do not promise a refund. Escalate documented extraordinary circumstances to a manager.
Member or promotional	Varies by offer	Use the offer terms shown at booking. A member discount does not by itself make a rate flexible.	Read the cancellation line, not only the promotional name.
Group or negotiated	Per signed agreement	Use the signed contract or group block terms. The baseline rule does not override a contract.	Send contract questions to Sales or the assigned account owner.

For reservations made through an online travel agency, the agency may process the charge and cancellation. AuroraStay should confirm the agency's terms and avoid promising that the hotel can reverse an agency charge directly.

3. Changes, no-shows, and special circumstances

A guest may request a date, room type, occupancy, or property change. Staff must price the modified reservation using the current available rate and verify whether the original rate plan permits the change. A modification is not complete until the new confirmation is issued.

If a guest does not arrive by the property cutoff, the reservation is treated as a no-show unless the guest has arranged a late arrival. The baseline charge is one night plus applicable tax for flexible rates. A multi-night reservation may be released after the first night unless the property has received payment or written notice for the rest of the stay.

If a property cannot honor a confirmed reservation because of an overbooking or an operational closure, the manager on duty must arrange a comparable room when feasible, cover approved reasonable relocation costs, and document the resolution. The manager must not describe a relocation as a guest cancellation.

A manager may approve a one-time exception for a documented service failure, duplicate booking, verified system error, or other approved service recovery. The reason, approver, amount, and guest communication must be recorded in the reservation record.

4. Taxes, deposits, and guarantees

Item	Baseline rule	What to tell the guest
Room and occupancy tax	Applied according to the property location and current tax setup.	Show the estimated total and explain that the final amount can change if local taxes or disclosed fees change.
Incidentals authorization	A temporary card authorization may be placed at arrival. The amount is property-specific and may be increased if charges are posted.	It is a hold, not a final charge. Release timing depends on the issuer after checkout.
Card guarantee	The card must be valid and authorized under the reservation terms. A failed guarantee requires prompt guest contact or manager review.	Use a valid card or an approved payment method before the cancellation deadline when required.

AuroraStay does not store full payment card numbers in guest notes. Staff must use the approved payment system and follow PCI DSS controls. Never request a card number by email or ordinary chat.

5. Property-specific quick reference

The following matrix is a training reference for six representative properties. Always verify the live property profile and reservation confirmation before quoting a guest. Amounts are in US dollars and exclude tax unless the row says otherwise.

Property	Check-in / out	Parking	Pets	Breakfast
ASH-ATL Midtown, Atlanta GA	3:00 PM / 11:00 AM	Self parking, $28 per night	$75 per stay; 2 pets max	$19 adult, $10 child
ASH-BOS Harbor, Boston MA	4:00 PM / 11:00 AM	Valet only, $65 per night	No pets except service animals	Included with room
ASH-CHI Loop, Chicago IL	3:00 PM / 12:00 PM	Self parking, $42 per night	$50 per night, $150 stay cap	$22 per person
ASH-DEN Union, Denver CO	4:00 PM / 11:00 AM	Garage, $35 per night	$75 per stay; 2 pets max	$18 per person
ASH-MIA Brickell, Miami FL	4:00 PM / 11:00 AM	Valet, $55 per night	$100 per stay; 2 pets max	$24 per person
ASH-SEA Pike, Seattle WA	3:00 PM / 12:00 PM	No on-site parking; partner garage, $38 per night	$75 per stay; 2 pets max	Included with room

Property profile rule
A property profile may contain a more specific parking, pet, breakfast, or arrival rule. Do not transfer a fee from one property to another. If a property is not in the matrix, use the live property profile or contact the property.

6. Reference and review notes

This baseline should be reviewed with Revenue Management, Finance, Guest Experience, and each property leader before publishing a new rate plan. Review state and local requirements for lodging taxes, fee disclosures, cancellation restrictions, accessibility, and consumer protection before changing the rule.

Regulatory alignment to confirm during review includes the Federal Trade Commission's rules and guidance on clear pricing and unfair or deceptive practices, applicable state automatic renewal or fee disclosure requirements, and the Americans with Disabilities Act Title III requirements for places of lodging. The property owner remains responsible for local implementation.

7. Cancellation and change workflow

Step	Owner	Required check	Record
1. Locate reservation	Any agent	Match name, confirmation, property, dates, rate plan, and booking channel.	Reservation ID
2. Read rate terms	Any agent	Confirm cancellation deadline, charge, payment status, and restrictions.	Rate rule quoted to guest
3. Check property rule	Property team	Confirm property-specific policy, event restriction, or operational limitation.	Profile or manager name
4. Complete or escalate	Agent or manager	Issue new confirmation, process eligible refund, or escalate exception.	Action, amount, approver, guest notice

Escalate when the confirmation conflicts with the property profile, the booking channel will not release a charge, the guest alleges discrimination or disability-related harm, the guest disputes an unauthorized charge, or the requested exception could create a legal or safety issue.

Document decisions in neutral language. Do not record sensitive medical details, full payment card data, or assumptions about a guest's identity or intent.